MOHAMMED RAZA NATHANI

ACCA, CIMA, CISI and B.Sc. (Hons.)

+971-567865565 raza.nathani@hotmail.com linkedin.com/in/mrnathani Dubai, United Arab Emirates

SUMMARY

An ACCA, CIMA, CISI qualified professional with a B.Sc. (Hons.) in Finance with 8+ years of experience in business management, financial planning and analysis along with commodity hedging. I possess strong evaluation and analytical skills regarding business reports and financial statements. Through my attention to detail and strong communication skills, I ensure accurate and timely execution of business actions. My expertise in Microsoft products and technology makes him a valuable asset to the team. My enthusiasm to contribute to the company's success is evident in my commitment to continuous improvement and development.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Operations

MIJ INTERNATIONAL 06/2024 - Present Dubai, United Arab Emirates

A non-ferrous metals trading company involved in imports/exports and cross-trading scrap and finished materials like copper, lead, aluminium, etc. The group also manages commodity price risk using LME/CME hedging and operates metal processing activities including battery recycling plant through its regional operations.

- Project-managed ERP + CTRM implementation (Microsoft Dynamics 365 BC) valued at USD 1.0M, delivering blueprint to go-live on time and enabling controlled workflows, approvals, and adoption across 80 users in 3 locations.
- Directed end-to-end operational governance across trading, hedging, logistics, plant execution, and Finance & Accounting using ERP controls + real-time dashboards to detect risks early, prevent impact and avoiding losses.
- Owned the operational digitalization roadmap through workflow automation to create a smooth flow of responsibilities reducing cycle timings by 36%.
- Built 6+ interactive BI dashboards for leadership visibility on market exposure, yields & costing, counterparty margins, logistics risk, claims recovery, shipment statuses, and operational bottlenecks.
- Established a daily and weekly executive MIS cadence involving flash reports on risk exposures, shipments, inventory, credit utilisation, claims, and plant KPIs, improving management decision turnaround.
- Designed an operational control framework embedding 20+ KPIs, checks, and approval gates across procurement, contracts, inventory, dispatch, documentation, hedging and settlement, resulting in improvement in audit readiness.
- Implemented SOPs and tightened internal controls through policies to reduce leakages and execution variability closing 13 procedural gaps via system controls and accountability.
- Owned contract-to-cash governance by improving payment terms, claims windows with the clients reducing disputes by 10% and improving collections by 3 days.
- Established provisional pricing & QP controls reducing unhedged exposure and improving fixation timeliness.
- Designed a model to earn maximum market spreads increasing the deal profitability with 0.3%.
- Implemented IFRS 9-aligned hedging governance, improving hedge compliance and reducing P&L volatility.
- Chaired enterprise risk reviews and monitored risk appetite; escalated breaches early and executed mitigations.
- Built a formal planning platform to optimise the resource (man-power and plant infrastructure) utilisation and proper container management to reduce the demurrage/detention and quicker inventory turnaround.
- Partnered with management to redesign the legal structure for stronger local compliance and reporting transparency, enabling improved bank terms including 22% higher credit facilities and a 40 bps reduction in interest rates.
- Led end-to-end project management for a new Battery Recycling + Copper Refinery facility in West Africa, defining stage gates, milestones, cost tracking, and risk controls to drive execution from setup through commissioning.

SKILLS

Operational Strategy · Execution Leadership · Enterprise Governance & Internal Controls · KPI Design · Operating Cadence · Cross-functional Leadership · Stakeholder Management · Commodity Trading Operations · Commodity Hedging · QP Management · Derivative Analysis · Critical Analysis of Forex · Risk Management · Project Management · Contract Management · Due Diligence · Business Strategy · Financial Reporting · Corporate Finance · Management Accounting · IFRS · Quantitative Analysis · Evaluation · Data Modelling · Data Automation · Business Advisory · Business Valuation · Professionalism · Resource Management · Time Management · Advance Technology Expertise

TECHNOLOGY SKILLS

Microsoft Office 365 · Microsoft Fabric · Microsoft Dynamics 365 · Microsoft Power BI · Microsoft Visio · Microsoft Power Apps · Microsoft Project Professional · Bloomberg Terminal · FastMarkets · LSEG Refinitiv Workspace · Amazon Web Services · Tally ERP · Oracle NetSuite · SAP · Workday Adaptive Planning · Artificial Intelligence (AI)

EXPERIENCE

Regional Financial Controller - FP&A

YouGov | 08/2023 - 05/2024 | Mumbai, India

An international online research data and analytics technology group. Heading Financial Planning and Analysis for UK region responsible for business planning, forecast, budgeting and analysing the overheads. Controller of internally generated software and capitalising it.

- Led end-to-end regional FP&A covering forecasting, budgeting, and strategic planning across 6 countries and 4 business units, supporting executive decision-making and growth prioritization.
- Capitalised £2 million internally generated software developments based on IAS 38 criteria in FY23.
- Streamlined staff costs and headcount controls document analysing the actuals with the forecasts and budgets.
- Liaising with the technical department leaders to know the status of each project and give them an insight of spends being done.
- Owned the regional P&L and delivered monthly performance reviews, improving leadership visibility and enabling faster corrective actions.
- Presenting the capex and project status to the board along with CFO.
- Approving monthly fixed asset additions and depreciation / amortization entries post reviewing.
- Automated recurring management reporting packs, reducing manual reporting effort from 3 hours/week to 0.75 hours/week and improving data consistency and cutting reporting time.
- Recognising the projects eligible for R&D credits as per HMRC regulations.
- Developed scenario models for leadership covering headcount, utilisation, panel costs, FX impacts, enabling proactive cost and cash decisions.
- Forecasting quarterly overheads in management packs.
- Liaising with HR Business Partner to control the hiring, promotions, increments and attrition to align with the budgeted open roles.

Associate Consultant, Deputy Finance Controller

Capgemini | 11/2021 - 07/2023 | Mumbai, India

Capgemini is a global leader in partnering with companies to transform and manage their business by harnessing the power of technology. As Deputy Finance Controller for North America Finance, I controlled overheads and professional resources in India, the United States, and Canada within the Cloud and Custom Applications Department. Also served as the Financial Controller for Capgemini's North America operations through its subsidiary, Liquid Hub Analytics Pvt. Ltd.

- Forecasted monthly expected costs, revenue and professional resources assigned on a project to be in-line with the yearly budget
- Reported actual monthly figures relating to cost, revenue and resource utilisation
- Performed interpretation of reported figures with forecast and budget along with analysing the reasons for the variances
- Prepared revenue statement for the North America practices along with a client-wise summary
- Discharged revenue that came from intercompany projects and performed invoicing for the same
- Managed resources on every grade to plan the attrition or promotion under the yearly budget and increment percentages
- Looked after all the project codes that comes under C&CA for assessing the time booked by the resources and the rates charged to the client
- Evaluated the time charged by the resources are in-lined with the company's statement of work
- Prepared MIS reports as per requirements
- Participated in computing geo-wise cost rates at different grades
- Actively involved in the budget creation process for 2023 adhering to the guidelines
- Managed the accounts of the clients including McDonalds, Starbucks, KPMG, PwC, Grant Thornton, Volvo, Mercedes and US Defence totalling to over USD 20 million in revenue

ACHIEVEMENTS

Future Leader Award - Male by World Federation of KSIMC, UK

Find out more on - http://lnkiy.in/YouthAward

Chief Guest Appearance in Finance event of HR College of Commerce and Economics, Mumbai, India

Find out more on - http://lnkiy.in/HRCollege

VOLUNTEERING

WF Youth Lead

The World Federation of KSIMC

06/2023 - Present | London, UK

The World Federation of KSIMC is an NGO in special consultative status with the economic and social council (ECOSOC) of the United Nations. We provide humanitarian services, emergency relief, international development, institutional reform, organisational grants, member advocacy, community leadership and religious guidance to the youths.

Find out more on - https://www.world-federation.org/community-affairs/youth-task-force

EXPERIENCE

Associate, Statutory Audit

Grant Thornton 06/2017 - 06/2021 Mumbai, India

GT is one of the preeminent professional services firms and offers end-to-end solutions for a business lifecycle through services spanning Assurance, Tax, Advisory, Technology and Consulting. As an Audit Associate of listed entities with the responsibilities of applying technical auditing and analysing skills in the key areas of the client's operations. Also learned how to comply with statutory laws and stock exchange regulations by having professional scepticism on every segment.

- Implementation of IFRS into three client's accounting system
- Audit Planning
- Test of controls and walking through the operations of the organisation to determine their efficiency
- Created budgets along with tracking and analysing cost reports
- Performed complex debt fund accounting treatment
- Gained expertise in identifying Key Risk Areas in the organisation
- Performed pre-audit procedures by opening balance testing from previous year's closing
- Preparation of trail balance, consolidated financial statements and cash flow statements
- Calculated the statutory dues (VAT) along with proportionate penalties
- Estimated Net Asset Value after revaluation, amortization and upgrades
- Prepared work-papers, documentation and evidence collection
- Performed Analytical Procedures
- Reconciled bank statements and intercompany balances with the confirmations from the banks and external parties
- Learned the collection process of the bank and credit card along with the derivative structure
- Computed the gain and loss in foreign transactions
- Interpreted material variances to previous quarters/years or budget
- Performed closure process by cross-checking the accounting of the events occurred after the reporting period
- Performed the above skills with Computer Assisted Audit Techniques and Audit Management software, Attestation process and Issuance of Certificates as per Statutory Requirements

EDUCATION

Higher Secondary Certificate

K.J. Somaiya College of Arts and Commerce

06/2015 - 03/2017 Mumbai, India

ACCA

Association of Chartered Certified Accountants

05/2017 - 10/2020 London, UK

CIMA

Chartered Institute of Management Accountants

06/2017 - Present London, UK

CISI

Chartered Institute of Securities and Investments

06/2018 - 10/2018 London, UK

Bachelors of Science (B.Sc.) (Hons.) in Applied Accounting

Oxford Brookes University 06/2017 - 10/2021 Oxford, UK